Policy & Strategy Lab

Instructor Guide, Week 4: Decide, deliver, defend

This guide covers Days 16 to 20. Each day follows the same pattern: an overview, the session plan, preparation, a slide-by-slide teaching narrative that matches the day's PowerPoint, likely misconceptions, discussion questions with what strong answers include, full facilitation notes for the activity, the workbook application, assessment, readings and the transition to the next day.

The running case in every demonstration is Madhyapur, a stylised city. Its figures are illustrative and must never be presented as real data. Rules, schemes and institutions named alongside it (the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016, Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban) 2.0, the Seventh and Twelfth Schedules) are real; check current details before teaching.

Day 16: Generating options

Item	Detail
Week	4: Decide, deliver, defend (Monday)
Central question	How do we generate genuinely different options without jumping to the first attractive idea?
Session outcome	Each participant has generated at least three distinct options and a do-minimum baseline from a journey map of the affected group.
Competencies	G1, G2, C4
Anchor tool	How Might We questions with a journey map
Supporting tools (demonstrated only)	Desirability, feasibility and viability; A quick impact and effort screen; Orders of change
Theory link	Peter Hall: Are you adjusting settings, changing instruments or changing goals?
Gate	No gate today.

Learning objectives

1. Map the affected group's journey using published evidence.
2. Frame How Might We questions at the points where the journey breaks.
3. Generate options that differ in mechanism, at different orders of change.
4. Screen options quickly on impact and effort, without choosing yet.

Session plan

Minutes	Block	Length
0 to 10	Opening problem	10 minutes
10 to 30	Concept: options, not solutions	20 minutes
30 to 50	Demonstration: Madhyapur options	20 minutes
50 to 85	Activity: policy innovation lab	35 minutes
85 to 110	Own case: options canvas	25 minutes
110 to 120	Debrief and exit task	10 minutes

Preparation and materials

- The Day 16 slide deck (03 Slides)
- Worksheet 7.1 in Workbook 7
- Case card with journey evidence (case bank, case 5)
- How Might We cards
- Impact and effort grid

Indian policy context

Options for access to primary healthcare in remote areas range from bringing care closer (outreach, telemedicine), to bringing people to care (transport), to changing who provides it (community health workers), to changing when people seek it. These are different mechanisms, not variations of one idea.

Teaching narrative, slide by slide

Slide 1. Title slide. Week 4 begins, and with it the eightfold path: alternatives, criteria, outcomes, trade-offs, decision and story. Return Gate 3 feedback tomorrow.

Slide 2. Today. Session outcome: by the end of the session each participant has generated at least three distinct options and a do-minimum baseline from a journey map of the affected group.

Slide 3. Opening problem. Most people find the second and third hard. The first idea is usually the one they had before the course began. Today's tools exist to get past it.

Slide 4. A journey map: a Madhyapur household. Journey mapping comes from service design practice, including IDEO's human-centred design work. In this course it is built from published evidence: field studies, audits, social audits and credible reporting. Ask where the Madhyapur journey breaks: storage, timing and observation.

Slide 5. How Might We: turning breaks into questions. The How Might We formulation is widely associated with IDEO and design thinking, though accounts trace it to earlier innovation practice at Procter & Gamble. Test each question: if it contains a solution (how might we give everyone bins?) it is too narrow; if it restates the problem it is too broad.

Slide 6. Options at three orders of change. Hall's three orders. Most first ideas are settings changes: do more of what we already do. They are cheap and politically easy, and often insufficient when the diagnosis points at the instrument itself, as it does in Madhyapur.

Slide 7. Madhyapur: three options and a baseline. Each option traces back to a finding: A to the contract (H1), B to processing and to the absent voices (H3 and Day 7), C to enforcement (H4, where the rival was supported, which already warns against C on its own).

Slide 8. A quick screen, not a decision: impact and effort. This is where the intervention-ranking tools belong, not on Day 8. ICE scoring comes from growth practice in technology firms; its confidence term is useful because it forces a statement of how sure we are about impact.

Slide 9. Desirability, feasibility, viability. Run the three questions quickly on each Madhyapur option. B is highly desirable to pickers and plausibly to households; its feasibility depends on the cooperative's capacity. Tomorrow's appraisal turns these impressions into explicit, weighted criteria.

Slide 10. A thinker for your case. Peter Hall, "Policy Paradigms, Social Learning, and the State", Comparative Politics, 1993. Hall distinguished first-order change (adjusting the settings of existing instruments), second-order change (new instruments) and third-order change (new goals and ways of seeing the problem). Put the question to the room: Are you adjusting settings, changing instruments or changing goals? Then ask each participant to answer it for their own case in one sentence.

Slide 11. Activity: Policy innovation lab. Enforce the no-judging rule during ideation: the sceptic role is suspended for ten minutes, then reinstated for grouping. Pods often produce eight versions of a mobile clinic. Ask what different mechanisms exist: bringing care closer, bringing people to care, changing who provides care, or changing when people seek it.

Slide 12. Your case: Worksheet 7.1. Individual application, about 20 minutes. Circulate and check that every participant is working on their own case. Ask each participant to state the mechanism of each option in one verb phrase; identical verbs mean identical options.

Slide 13. What to take away. Ask two participants to state the takeaway they found least obvious, then close with the exit task: Write your three options as three different mechanisms, in five words each.

Slide 14. Before the next session. For each option, find one published example of something similar being tried, in India or elsewhere, and note what happened. About 50 minutes.

Likely misconceptions

Misconception	How to respond
Brainstorming means anything goes.	Ideation suspends judgement briefly; the final options must still trace back to the diagnosis.
The best option is the most innovative.	The best option fits the diagnosis, the decision-maker's powers and the capacity to deliver.
A baseline is a waste of time.	Without it there is nothing to compare against, and doing nothing is always an option.

Discussion questions

Question	What strong answers include
Why include a do-minimum baseline?	Every option must justify its costs against what would happen anyway. Strong answers describe what the baseline would look like in their case.
When is a settings change the right recommendation?	When the instrument is sound but poorly used. Strong answers use their diagnosis to decide.

Activity: Policy innovation lab

Element	Detail
Purpose	Generate a wide set of genuinely different options for a common case before choosing any.
Scenario	People in remote villages of a stylised hill district travel long distances to reach a functioning primary health centre, and many delay care until they are seriously ill. Generate options for the district health officer.
Group size	Pods of four
Time	35 minutes
Materials	Case card with journey evidence (case bank, case 5); How Might We cards; Impact and effort grid
Expected output	Three distinct options and a baseline, screened

Steps.

1. Map the patient's journey from first symptom to treatment, using the case card.
2. Mark three breaks and write a How Might We question for each.
3. Generate at least eight ideas in ten minutes, without judging.
4. Group them into three options that differ in mechanism, plus a baseline.
5. Run a quick impact and effort screen. Do not choose yet.

Facilitation. Enforce the no-judging rule during ideation: the sceptic role is suspended for ten minutes, then reinstated for grouping. Pods often produce eight versions of a mobile clinic. Ask what different mechanisms exist: bringing care closer, bringing people to care, changing who provides care, or changing when people seek it.

Debrief questions.

- Which How Might We question produced the most different ideas?
- Which of your options changes an instrument, and which only a setting?
- What would the patient, the frontline worker and the finance officer each say about your best option?

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Three options that differ in mechanism	Variants of one idea presented as options
A do-minimum baseline	Choosing during ideation
Options traced to breaks in the journey	Options unconnected to the diagnosis

Extension for strong groups. Design a combined or sequenced option from two of your three.

Workbook application: Worksheet 7.1, Options canvas

Generate genuinely different options from the breaks in the affected group's experience. Ask each participant to state the mechanism of each option in one verb phrase; identical verbs mean identical options.

Hand in. Worksheet 7.1 by the start of Day 17.

Independent work

For each option, find one published example of something similar being tried, in India or elsewhere, and note what happened. About 50 minutes.

Assessment

Feeds the options appraisal and the client report. Feedback uses G1, G2 and C4 and tracker codes DE1 and DE2.

Readings

- Essential: Brown, Tim. "Design Thinking." Harvard Business Review, June 2008.
- Optional: Hall, "Policy Paradigms, Social Learning, and the State" (1993), the section on orders of change.

Close and transition

Exit task: Write your three options as three different mechanisms, in five words each. Transition: Tomorrow you compare the options against explicit criteria, and choose.

Day 17: Choosing between options

Item	Detail
Week	4: Decide, deliver, defend (Tuesday)
Central question	Which option should we recommend, and why is it better than the alternatives?
Session outcome	Each participant has appraised your options against explicit criteria, estimated cost per outcome, tested sensitivity, applied the public value test, and chosen.
Competencies	G3, G4, G5, J2
Anchor tool	Options appraisal matrix with a distributional row
Supporting tools (demonstrated only)	Cost per outcome; Sensitivity testing; Moore's strategic triangle; Incremental and comprehensive choice
Theory link	Mark Moore, with Charles Lindblom: Does the option create public value, can it win legitimacy and support, and is there the capacity to deliver it?
Gate	No gate today.

Learning objectives

1. Choose and weight explicit criteria, including distribution and feasibility.
2. Score each option, and the baseline, with a reason for every score.
3. Estimate rough cost per unit of outcome and test whether the ranking depends on assumptions.
4. Test the preferred option for public value, legitimacy and support, and operational capacity.

Session plan

Minutes	Block	Length
0 to 10	Opening problem	10 minutes
10 to 30	Concept: criteria and weights	20 minutes
30 to 50	Demonstration: Madhyapur appraisal	20 minutes
50 to 85	Activity: decision committee	35 minutes
85 to 100	Own case: options appraisal	15 minutes
100 to 110	Pod check of appraisals	10 minutes
110 to 120	Exit task	10 minutes

Preparation and materials

- The Day 17 slide deck (03 Slides)
- Worksheet 7.2 in Workbook 7
- Committee role cards with criteria
- Scoring sheet
- Budget card

Indian policy context

Indian public decisions are rarely made on cost-effectiveness alone. Finance departments weigh cost, implementing departments weigh capacity, elected representatives weigh support, and affected groups weigh who gains and who pays. An appraisal that makes these criteria and their weights explicit is easier to defend.

Teaching narrative, slide by slide

Slide 1. Title slide. Return Gate 3 feedback. Today includes a short pod check of each appraisal before the session ends; the instructor comments in writing before Day 18.

Slide 2. Today. Session outcome: by the end of the session each participant has appraised your options against explicit criteria, estimated cost per outcome, tested sensitivity, applied the public value test, and chosen.

Slide 3. Opening problem. Most people choose on one criterion and justify it afterwards. The point of today is to make all the criteria, and the weight each carries, visible.

Slide 4. Criteria for appraising public options. This is Bardach's step of selecting criteria. The distribution row is non-negotiable in the Lab, in line with the programme's seventh principle. Ask participants who should set the weights: the analyst, the decision-maker, or both in discussion?

Slide 5. Options appraisal: Madhyapur (illustrative scores, 1 to 5). Check one weighted score aloud: option B is 0.3 times 3, plus 0.2 times 3, plus 0.15 times 3, plus 0.15 times 4, plus 0.1 times 5, plus 0.1 times 3, which is 3.35. The surprise is the baseline in second place. Multi-criteria analysis rewards doing nothing unless effectiveness carries enough weight. This is the most important lesson on the slide.

Slide 6. Cost per outcome, roughly (illustrative). A full cost-benefit analysis would need monetised benefits and data that are not available in four weeks. Cost per unit of outcome, with the driving assumption stated, is more honest at this stage. Full cost-benefit analysis is in the framework library as a reference tool.

Slide 7. Does the ranking survive a different assumption?. Sensitivity testing protects against false precision (J3). The finding that B depends on the cooperative's reach shapes the delivery design tomorrow: a pilot that tests reach before scaling.

Slide 8. The public value test: option B. Moore's strategic triangle adds legitimacy, which the design lens of desirability, feasibility and viability does not address directly. Ask participants to name the weakest leg for their own preferred option.

Slide 9. Comprehensive or incremental?. Lindblom's argument that muddling through by successive limited comparisons is often wiser. Flyvbjerg's work on large projects adds that starting small and learning fast reduces the risk of cost and time overruns. The sequenced option also addresses the sensitivity finding: the pilot tests the cooperative's reach.

Slide 10. A thinker for your case. Mark Moore, with Charles Lindblom, Creating Public Value (1995); "The Science of 'Muddling Through'" (1959). Moore's strategic triangle asks public managers to align value, support and capacity. Lindblom argued that comparing a few options step by step is often wiser than searching for a comprehensive best. Put the question to the room: Does the option create public value, can it win legitimacy and support, and is there the capacity to deliver it? Then ask each participant to answer it for their own case in one sentence.

Slide 11. Activity: The government decision committee. Rotate committee members so several participants play roles. Insist the committee states its weights before scoring; that makes visible that the decision is a value judgement. The citizens' representative should press on who is left out.

Slide 12. Your case: Worksheet 7.2. Individual application, about 20 minutes. Circulate and check that every participant is working on their own case. Check that the baseline has been scored. Many participants skip it, which hides the most important comparison.

Slide 13. What to take away. Ask two participants to state the takeaway they found least obvious, then close with the exit task: Write the one assumption your recommendation depends on most.

Slide 14. Before the next session. Write your recommendation in one paragraph: what, by whom, by when, at what cost, and what it depends on. About 45 minutes.

Likely misconceptions

Misconception	How to respond
The highest weighted score wins.	The score summarises judgements. If a small change in weights flips the ranking, say so and use judgement.
Cost-benefit analysis settles the question.	It needs data and monetised values usually unavailable in four weeks. Cost per outcome with stated assumptions is more honest here.
Political feasibility is cynical.	Support and legitimacy are part of public value. An option nobody will back cannot deliver value.

Discussion questions

Question	What strong answers include
Why does the baseline score well in the Madhyapur matrix?	Doing nothing is cheap and easy; the method rewards it unless effectiveness carries enough weight. Strong answers say how they set their own weights.
When is a sequenced recommendation better than a single choice?	When knowledge or capacity is limited and early steps build the capability later steps need. Strong answers cite Lindblom and their own case.

Activity: The government decision committee

Element	Detail
Purpose	Defend options before officials who judge them by different criteria.
Scenario	Pods present three options for the Day 16 primary healthcare case to a committee of four: a finance officer focused on cost, an implementing official focused on capacity, a representative of affected citizens focused on distribution, and a political adviser focused on support. The budget can fund one option fully or two partially.
Group size	Pods present in turn; four volunteers form the committee
Time	35 minutes
Materials	Committee role cards with criteria; Scoring sheet; Budget card
Expected output	A committee decision with explicit weights

Steps.

1. Each pod prepares a one-minute case for each of its three options.
2. Committee members question each option on their own criterion only.
3. The committee states its weights, then scores the options.
4. The pod revises its preferred option in response.
5. Debrief: whose criterion decided the outcome?

Facilitation. Rotate committee members so several participants play roles. Insist the committee states its weights before scoring; that makes visible that the decision is a value judgement. The citizens' representative should press on who is left out.

Debrief questions.

- Which criterion decided the outcome, and was its weight argued or assumed?
- How did the pods' preferred options change under questioning?
- What did the citizens' representative see that the others did not?

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Options defended on several criteria	Arguing on effectiveness alone
Weights stated	Ignoring the budget constraint
Distribution addressed	Treating political feasibility as cynical rather than real

Extension for strong groups. Rerun with a different budget. Does the choice change, and why?

Workbook application: Worksheet 7.2, Options appraisal

Choose between your options against explicit, weighted criteria, and show what the choice depends on. Check that the baseline has been scored. Many participants skip it, which hides the most important comparison.

Hand in. Worksheet 7.2 by the start of Day 18. Pods check each other's appraisals in the last ten minutes of today's session; the instructor comments in writing before Day 18.

Independent work

Write your recommendation in one paragraph: what, by whom, by when, at what cost, and what it depends on. About 45 minutes.

Assessment

Feeds the client report and the defence. A pod check of the appraisal ends today's session, with a written instructor comment before Day 18. Feedback uses G3, G4, G5 and J2 and tracker code DE3.

Readings

- Essential: Moore, Creating Public Value (1995), the chapter on defining public value.
- Optional: Lindblom, "The Science of 'Muddling Through'" (1959).
- Optional: Flyvbjerg and Gardner, How Big Things Get Done (2023), on reference-class forecasting.

Close and transition

Exit task: Write the one assumption your recommendation depends on most. Transition: Tomorrow: turning the choice into a plan that can actually be delivered.

Day 18: Designing for delivery

Item	Detail
Week	4: Decide, deliver, defend (Wednesday)
Central question	How does a good recommendation become a programme that actually works?
Session outcome	Each participant has built a theory of change, a responsibility matrix, a delivery approach and a risk register for your recommendation.
Competencies	H1, H2, H3, H4
Anchor tool	Theory of change
Supporting tools (demonstrated only)	RAPID or RACI; Strategy Palette with problem-driven iterative adaptation; Risk register
Theory link	Carol Weiss and Michael Lipsky: Which links in your theory of change are assumptions, and what will frontline workers actually do with the plan?
Gate	No gate today.

Learning objectives

1. Build a theory of change and mark which links are evidenced and which are assumed.
2. Assign decision rights and responsibilities with RAPID or RACI, using named roles.
3. Choose whether to plan in full or build as you learn, and justify it.
4. Identify and plan for the main risks, including frontline responses.

Session plan

Minutes	Block	Length
0 to 10	Opening problem	10 minutes
10 to 30	Concept: theory of change	20 minutes
30 to 50	Demonstration: Madhyapur delivery	20 minutes
50 to 85	Activity: implementation breakdown	35 minutes
85 to 110	Own case: implementation plan	25 minutes
110 to 120	Debrief and exit task	10 minutes

Preparation and materials

- The Day 18 slide deck (03 Slides)
- Worksheet 8.1 in Workbook 8
- Plan card (case bank, case 7)
- Six shock cards
- Theory of change template

Indian policy context

Audits of Indian schemes frequently find that outputs were delivered but outcomes did not follow, or that frontline staff were reassigned (for example to election duty) at critical moments. A delivery design that anticipates these failures is part of the recommendation, not an afterthought.

Teaching narrative, slide by slide

Slide 1. Title slide. Return the written comments on yesterday's appraisals. Today's work feeds directly into Gate 4 tomorrow.

Slide 2. Today. Session outcome: by the end of the session each participant has built a theory of change, a responsibility matrix, a delivery approach and a risk register for your recommendation.

Slide 3. Opening problem. Most lists are dominated by delivery reasons: staff, funds released late, coordination, frontline discretion, data. That is the case for today's session.

Slide 4. A theory of change for option B in Madhyapur. The theory of change has roots in theory-based evaluation, associated with Carol Weiss and the Aspen Institute's work on community initiatives in the 1990s, and is now used widely, including by the Bridgespan Group with its idea of intended impact. The link from outputs to outcomes is where many Indian schemes fail: bins delivered, behaviour unchanged.

Slide 5. The assumptions behind each link. The second row is a frontline assumption, Lipsky's territory: crews may divert recyclables because they currently sell some informally. A delivery design should either make that unnecessary (a shared income model) or monitor it.

Slide 6. RAPID: who holds which role in the key decision. Ask where decisions in the participants' cases typically stall in Indian administration: often at the Agree role, where finance or legal departments can block without owning the outcome. Naming the roles makes that risk visible.

Slide 7. Plan in full, or build as you learn?. The Strategy Palette (Reeves, Haanaes and Sinha) distinguishes five approaches: classical, adaptive, visionary, shaping and renewal. For most public delivery problems the useful choice is between classical and adaptive. Problem-driven iterative adaptation, from Andrews, Pritchett and Woolcock, is the public-sector version of the adaptive approach.

Slide 8. Risk register: Madhyapur option B (extract). Flyvbjerg's research on large projects shows that planners systematically underestimate cost and time. A useful check: what happened to the cost and timeline of similar efforts elsewhere? If no comparison exists, widen the likelihood estimates.

Slide 9. A thinker for your case. Carol Weiss and Michael Lipsky, Theory-based evaluation (1995); Street-Level Bureaucracy (1980). Weiss argued that programmes rest on implicit theories of how change happens, and that making them explicit lets them be tested. Lipsky reminds us that frontline workers reshape any plan they are asked to deliver. Put the question to the room: Which links in your theory of change are assumptions, and what will frontline workers actually do with the plan? Then ask each participant to answer it for their own case in one sentence.

Slide 10. Activity: Implementation breakdown simulation. Draw the same shocks for every pod so that plans can be compared. The election duty card is a reminder of how often frontline capacity disappears for reasons outside the programme. Ask which risks each pod had already anticipated.

Slide 11. Your case: Worksheet 8.1. Individual application, about 20 minutes. Circulate and check that every participant is working on their own case. Ask every participant which link in their theory of change is the Madhyapur-style outputs-to-outcomes gap.

Slide 12. What to take away. Ask two participants to state the takeaway they found least obvious, then close with the exit task: Write the assumption in your theory of change that is most likely to fail.

Slide 13. Before the next session. Draft your full deck (10 to 12 slides) using the capstone structure; Gate 4 reviews it tomorrow. About 60 minutes.

Likely misconceptions

Misconception	How to respond
A theory of change is a flowchart.	It is an argument about causes, with its assumptions marked for testing.
Implementation is someone else's job.	A recommendation that cannot be delivered is not a recommendation. Delivery design is part of the analysis.
More detail makes a better plan.	A plan should show who decides, who does, what could go wrong and how it will adapt. Detail without those is noise.

Discussion questions

Question	What strong answers include
Why do Indian programmes so often fail between outputs and outcomes?	Outputs can be delivered and counted without changing behaviour. Strong answers find that link in their own theory of change.
When is an adaptive approach irresponsible?	When mistakes are irreversible or the harm is severe, as in safety-critical infrastructure. Strong answers say why their case is or is not like that.

Activity: Implementation breakdown simulation

Element	Detail
Purpose	Stress-test an implementation plan against the shocks real programmes face.
Scenario	Each pod has a sound plan to expand evening bus services for women workers in a stylised city. Every five minutes the facilitator draws a shock card: a budget cut; a transport union objects to new shifts; a data system fails; frontline staff are reassigned to election duty; a safety incident causes public distrust; the state changes the scheme guidelines.
Group size	Pods of four
Time	35 minutes
Materials	Plan card (case bank, case 7); Six shock cards; Theory of change template
Expected output	A revised plan and a list of the links that proved fragile

Steps.

1. Read the plan and its theory of change.
2. When a shock card is drawn, decide in three minutes how the plan adapts.
3. Record which link in the theory of change each shock hit.
4. After four shocks, redraw the plan.
5. Compare across pods: which plans bent, and which broke?

Facilitation. Draw the same shocks for every pod so that plans can be compared. The election duty card is a reminder of how often frontline capacity disappears for reasons outside the programme. Ask which risks each pod had already anticipated.

Debrief questions.

- Which link in the theory of change was hit most often?
- Which shock had your pod anticipated, and which not?
- What would an adaptive plan have done differently from the start?

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Adaptations address the mechanism	Adding staff or money for every shock

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Fragile links identified	Ignoring frontline responses
The revised plan is coherent	Adaptations with no owner

Extension for strong groups. Add one early warning indicator for each fragile link.

Workbook application: Worksheet 8.1, Implementation plan

Show how your recommendation would actually be delivered: the causal logic, the people, the approach and the risks. Ask every participant which link in their theory of change is the Madhyapur-style outputs-to-outcomes gap.

Hand in. Worksheet 8.1 by the start of Day 19.

Independent work

Draft your full deck (10 to 12 slides) using the capstone structure; Gate 4 reviews it tomorrow. About 60 minutes.

Assessment

Feeds Gate 4 and the client report. Feedback uses H1 to H4 and tracker code EX1.

Readings

- Essential: Rogers and Blenko, "Who Has the D? How Clear Decision Roles Enhance Organizational Performance." Harvard Business Review (2006).
- Optional: Reeves, Haanaes and Sinha, Your Strategy Needs a Strategy (2015), the chapter on the adaptive approach.
- Optional: Andrews, Pritchett and Woolcock, Building State Capability (2017), on problem-driven iterative adaptation.

Close and transition

Exit task: Write the assumption in your theory of change that is most likely to fail. Transition: Tomorrow: how you will know it is working, and the pitch. Gate 4.

Day 19: Measurement and the pitch

Item	Detail
Week	4: Decide, deliver, defend (Thursday)
Central question	How will we know whether the recommendation is working, and can we make the case in five slides?
Session outcome	Each participant has built an indicator framework, drafted your deck, rehearsed the five-slide pitch and submitted Gate 4.
Competencies	H5, I2, I4
Anchor tool	Indicator framework (indicator tree)
Supporting tools (demonstrated only)	SMART indicators; Early warning and adaptive review; The five-slide pitch; Policy windows
Theory link	John Kingdon: Is there a window for this recommendation, and which stream is missing?
Gate	Gate 4 is due today.

Learning objectives

1. Separate input, output and outcome indicators.
2. Give each indicator a source, a baseline requirement and a frequency, and disaggregate at least one.
3. Link the riskiest assumptions to early indicators and review points.
4. Build and rehearse a five-slide pitch with the recommendation in the first minute.

Session plan

Minutes	Block	Length
0 to 10	Opening problem	10 minutes
10 to 30	Concept: indicators	20 minutes
30 to 45	Demonstration: Madhyapur indicators	15 minutes
45 to 80	Thursday challenge: five-slide challenge	35 minutes
80 to 110	Gate 4: rehearsal and peer review	30 minutes
110 to 120	Debrief and exit task	10 minutes

Preparation and materials

- The Day 19 slide deck (03 Slides)
- Worksheet 9.1 in Workbook 9
- Evidence dossier (case bank, case 10)
- Slide template in the Lab's visual style

Indian policy context

Indian scheme dashboards often report outputs, such as toilets built, bins distributed or trainings held, because they are easy to count. Outcome indicators, such as use, behaviour and health, are harder to collect and are where programmes are truly judged.

Teaching narrative, slide by slide

Slide 1. Title slide. Final Thursday challenge, and Gate 4. Tomorrow is the panel. Keep the indicators block tight so that rehearsal gets its full time.

Slide 2. Today. Session outcome: by the end of the session each participant has built an indicator framework, drafted your deck, rehearsed the five-slide pitch and submitted Gate 4.

Slide 3. Opening problem. Bins delivered is an output. Whether households separate, and whether separated waste is handled separately, are outcomes. Recall Day 14: in Madhyapur, separation barely rose where bins were given.

Slide 4. From money to outcomes: what each indicator tells you. The sequence mirrors the theory of change from Day 18. An indicator framework is the theory of change made measurable.

Slide 5. An indicator tree for Madhyapur, option B. An indicator tree works like an issue tree: the root is the outcome, the branches are the conditions for it, and the leaves are measurable. Check it for MECE gaps: is there a condition for the outcome with no indicator?

Slide 6. Indicator framework: Madhyapur (extract). Where no baseline exists, the first task of the pilot is to set one. Targets without baselines invite arbitrary numbers, which then drive behaviour, sometimes perversely.

Slide 7. Early warning: link the riskiest assumptions to indicators. This connects the adaptive delivery approach from Day 18 to measurement. Without early indicators, an adaptive plan has nothing to adapt to.

Slide 8. A thinker for your case. John Kingdon, Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies, 1984. Kingdon argued that policy change happens when three streams meet: a recognised problem, an available policy and favourable politics. When they align, a window opens, briefly. Put the question to the room: Is there a window for this recommendation, and which stream is missing? Then ask each participant to answer it for their own case in one sentence.

Slide 9. The five-slide pitch. Each slide needs an argument title: a full sentence stating its claim. Read the five titles of the Madhyapur pitch aloud as a model: fund a pickers' partnership now and pay for separated collection at renewal; separation fails at collection because the contract pays for weight; and so on.

Slide 10. Activity: The five-slide challenge. Most pods will open with background. Stop them at the end of slide one if the recommendation has not appeared. Then read only the five titles aloud: do they tell the whole story? That is the test of argument titles.

Slide 11. Gate 4: rehearsal and peer review (30 minutes). Circulate and time a few pitches yourself. The most common problems: the recommendation arrives on slide 4, and titles are topics rather than claims.

Slide 12. Your case: Worksheet 9.1. Individual application, about 20 minutes. Circulate and check that every participant is working on their own case. Read each participant's five titles aloud back to them; if you cannot state their recommendation from the titles, neither will the panel.

Slide 13. What to take away. Ask two participants to state the takeaway they found least obvious, then close with the exit task: Read your five slide titles to a neighbour. Ask them to tell your recommendation back to you.

Slide 14. Before the next session. Rehearse your pitch twice, timed. Prepare answers to the five red team questions for your own case. About 60 minutes.

Likely misconceptions

Misconception	How to respond
More indicators mean better monitoring.	A few indicators that track the theory of change, especially its riskiest links, are more useful than many.
Targets should always be set.	Set targets only where there is a baseline and a reasoned expectation; otherwise set a review point.
A pitch is a summary of the report.	A pitch is an argument for a decision, in the order a decision-maker needs it.

Discussion questions

Question	What strong answers include
Why do programmes report outputs rather than outcomes?	Outputs are easy to count and within the programme's control. Strong answers propose a feasible outcome indicator for their own case.
What does the idea of a policy window imply for timing a recommendation?	A sound recommendation may wait for problem, policy and politics to align, and should be ready when they do. Strong answers name an event in their case that could open a window.

Activity: The five-slide challenge

Element	Detail
Purpose	Compress a complex analysis into a five-slide story with the recommendation first.
Scenario	Each pod takes the evidence dossier from Day 15 (take-up of a maternity benefit scheme) and builds five slides for the district collector, following the five-slide structure. Pods then present in four minutes, not six, to raise the pressure.
Group size	Pods of four
Time	35 minutes (Thursday challenge)
Materials	Evidence dossier (case bank, case 10); Slide template in the Lab's visual style
Expected output	Five slides with argument titles

Steps.

1. Agree the recommendation and the decision required, in one sentence.
2. Assign one slide to each member; the chair takes slide one.
3. Write argument titles: each title states the slide's claim.
4. Present in four minutes; another pod times and questions you.
5. Revise your weakest slide title.

Facilitation. Most pods will open with background. Stop them at the end of slide one if the recommendation has not appeared. Then read only the five titles aloud: do they tell the whole story? That is the test of argument titles.

Debrief questions.

- Did the five titles alone tell the story?
- Which slide was hardest to cut down, and why?
- What did the four-minute limit force you to drop, and was it right to drop it?

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Recommendation first	Background first

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Argument titles	Topic titles
Evidence and confidence shown	Too many numbers on one slide

Extension for strong groups. Turn your five titles into a 100-word executive summary.

Workbook application: Worksheet 9.1, Indicator framework and draft deck

Show how anyone would know whether your recommendation is working, and make the case in five slides. Read each participant's five titles aloud back to them; if you cannot state their recommendation from the titles, neither will the panel.

Hand in. Gate 4 (Worksheets 7.1, 7.2, 8.1 and 9.1, revised, with the draft deck) by the end of Day 19. Brief written feedback is returned before Day 20.

Independent work

Rehearse your pitch twice, timed. Prepare answers to the five red team questions for your own case. About 60 minutes.

Assessment

Gate 4: brief written feedback on domains G and H and on the deck (I2), returned before Day 20. Formative.

Readings

- Essential: Kingdon, Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies, the chapter on the policy window.
- Optional: The results framework or indicator list published for your scheme, if one exists: compare its indicators with yours.

Close and transition

Exit task: Read your five slide titles to a neighbour. Ask them to tell your recommendation back to you. Transition: Tomorrow: the panel. Present, defend, and learn what your analysis can withstand.

Day 20: The defence

Item	Detail
Week	4: Decide, deliver, defend (Friday)
Central question	Can you defend your analysis and recommendation before a decision-making panel?
Session outcome	Each participant has presented your recommendation, defended it under questioning and contributed to your pod's synthesis.
Competencies	I4, I5, J2
Anchor tool	Panel presentation and defence
Supporting tools (demonstrated only)	The pod synthesis slide; Opening the sealed answer
Theory link	None today.
Gate	No gate today.

Learning objectives

1. Present your recommendation in six minutes, answer first.
2. Defend the evidence, assumptions and feasibility under questioning.
3. Concede uncertainty without abandoning the argument.
4. Draw lessons across your pod's cases.

Session plan

Minutes	Block	Length
0 to 5	Panel briefing	5 minutes
5 to 95	Presentations and defence	90 minutes
95 to 107	Pod synthesis slides	12 minutes
107 to 115	Sealed answers returned	8 minutes
115 to 120	Close	5 minutes

Preparation and materials

- The Day 20 slide deck (03 Slides)
- Worksheet 10.1 in Workbook 10
- Timer and time cards
- Panel role cards and question bank
- Scoring sheets

Indian policy context

Briefings to senior officials and ministers in India are often short and interrupted. Analysts who lead with the decision, answer the question asked and state uncertainty plainly are the ones whose work is used.

Teaching narrative, slide by slide

Slide 1. Title slide. The timing assumes about nine presentations. For a cohort of sixteen, run two parallel panels or extend the session to about three and a half hours (see the Capstone Guide). Brief the panel before participants arrive.

Slide 2. Today. Session outcome: by the end of the session each participant has presented your recommendation, defended it under questioning and contributed to your pod's synthesis.

Slide 3. How today works. Keep this to two minutes. Announce the running order and remind participants that the client report is due 72 hours after the session ends, so the panel's questions are a gift: the report can answer them.

Slide 4. The panel. Brief panellists in advance: one question each, then follow-ups; no speeches; firm but not hostile. The citizen representative's role ensures the distributional question is always asked.

Slide 5. Questions the panel may ask. Panellists should choose questions that probe each participant's weakest area, which the instructor can flag from the Analyst Development Tracker.

Slide 6. Answering well under questioning. This is competency I5. Remind participants that the rubric rewards honest handling of uncertainty and penalises overstatement.

Slide 7. The pod synthesis slide. This is where transfer becomes visible: the same method applied to four different problems. If pods share a state or city, the institutional pattern is usually striking.

Slide 8. Activity: The final boardroom presentation. Brief the panel beforehand: one question each, then follow-ups, no speeches, no hostile questioning. With more than about nine participants, run two parallel panels or extend the session. Keep strict time.

Slide 9. Opening the sealed answer. Return the sealed answers individually. Give participants five minutes to read them. Invite two or three volunteers to say in one sentence what changed. The spine case is a useful model: the sealed answer survived, but the diagnosis had to absorb a rival explanation (vehicle compartments) and the recommendation became a sequence.

Slide 10. Your case: Worksheet 10.1. Individual application, about 20 minutes. Circulate and check that every participant is working on their own case. Remind participants that the report is where the panel's questions get proper answers.

Slide 11. What to take away. Ask two participants to state the takeaway they found least obvious, then close with the exit task: Write down the one skill from this course you will use first in your next piece of work.

Slide 12. Before the next session. Write and submit the capstone within 72 hours. Use the panel's questions: the report should answer each of them.

Likely misconceptions

Misconception	How to respond
The panel is trying to catch you out.	The panel is testing whether the analysis holds; good questions help you strengthen the report.
Conceding a point loses marks.	The rubric rewards honest handling of uncertainty and penalises overstatement.
The presentation is the final word.	The report, due 72 hours later, is where you answer the panel properly.

Discussion questions

Question	What strong answers include
What did the panel ask most often across the cohort?	Usually feasibility and who loses. Strong answers explain how the report will address it.
How did the sealed answer compare with the final recommendation?	Most change in emphasis or mechanism. Strong reflections trace each change to specific evidence.

Activity: The final boardroom presentation

Element	Detail
Purpose	Present and defend a recommendation before a decision-making panel, as in professional practice.
Scenario	Each participant presents a five-slide pitch to a panel playing the decision-maker, a finance officer, an implementing official and a citizen representative. Six minutes of presentation are followed by six minutes of questions. Pods then present their synthesis slides.
Group size	Individual presentations, grouped by pod
Time	About 12 minutes per participant
Materials	Timer and time cards; Panel role cards and question bank; Scoring sheets
Expected output	A presentation, a defence and a pod synthesis slide

Steps.

1. Present your five slides in six minutes; the chair shows a card at five.
2. Answer the panel's questions for six minutes.
3. Note the question you found hardest.
4. Pods present their synthesis slide in three minutes.
5. Collect your sealed answer at the close.

Facilitation. Brief the panel beforehand: one question each, then follow-ups, no speeches, no hostile questioning. With more than about nine participants, run two parallel panels or extend the session. Keep strict time.

Debrief questions.

- Which question exposed something your analysis had not covered?
- Where did you concede, and did it cost you?
- What will you change in the client report before it is due?

Evaluation criteria	Common errors
Recommendation in the first minute	Background first
Direct, evidenced answers	Defending every point
Uncertainty conceded where warranted	Reading slides aloud

Extension for strong groups. Write the paragraph you wish you had given in answer to the hardest question, and put it in the report.

Workbook application: Worksheet 10.1, Capstone submission

Turn the panel's challenge into a stronger final report, and reflect on how your thinking changed. Remind participants that the report is where the panel's questions get proper answers.

Hand in. Client report, final deck, evidence register, reflection and AI disclosure within 72 hours of the end of Day 20.

Independent work

Write and submit the capstone within 72 hours. Use the panel's questions: the report should answer each of them.

Assessment

Presentation and defence: 15 per cent, individual. Pod synthesis: 5 per cent. Client report: 20 per cent. Evidence register: 15 per cent. Workbook portfolio: 35 per cent, assessed after submission.

Readings

- Optional: Your own Analyst Development Tracker: read the codes that recurred across the four gates before writing the report.

Close and transition

Exit task: Write down the one skill from this course you will use first in your next piece of work. Transition: Submit the capstone within 72 hours. Final feedback follows, together with the comparison of your entry and exit diagnostics.